

Fables & Morals: Set 2

Grade 3 Reading Worksheet

The Proud Peacock and the Plain Sparrow

Percy the peacock loved his bright feathers. Every day he fanned his tail and said, Look how fine I am! A plain brown sparrow hopped nearby, looking for seeds. One rainy day, a hawk swooped down. Percy froze, but the sparrow darted into the bushes and hid. Percy learned that bright feathers do not keep you safe, but quick wits do.

1. What is the moral of this fable?
 - a. Rainy days are the best days.
 - b. Feathers are the most important thing.
 - c. Showing off does not keep you safe; quick thinking does.
2. What happened on the rainy day?
 - a. The peacock flew away
 - b. A hawk swooped down
 - c. The sparrow sang
3. How did the sparrow escape the hawk?

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Grade 3 Reading Worksheet

Hazel the Helpful Hedgehog

Hazel the hedgehog found a pile of sweet apples under a tree. She could not eat them all alone. Along came Oliver the owl, who was hungry. Hazel shared half her apples with him. That night, a storm blew down Hazel's leafy nest. Oliver saw it and hooted to his friends. The birds brought twigs, and soon Hazel had a new home.

1. What is the moral of this fable?
 - a. Storms are fun to watch.
 - b. Apples taste best at night.
 - c. A small gift can grow into a big friendship.

2. What happened to Hazel's nest?
 - a. The owl took it
 - b. It caught fire
 - c. A storm blew it down

3. How did Oliver repay Hazel's kindness?

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Grade 3 Reading Worksheet

The Frog Who Roared

Freddy the frog was tired of his tiny croak. I want a big, scary voice like Leo the lion, he said. He puffed up his throat and roared all day. Soon his throat hurt, and no one came near the pond. A wise old turtle said, Your croak calls your friends home. Freddy tried his soft croak again, and his friends hopped over.

1. What is the moral of this fable?
 - a. Ponds are quiet places.
 - b. Lions are the loudest animals.
 - c. Be happy with who you are.

2. What happened when Freddy roared all day?
 - a. He became a lion
 - b. His throat hurt
 - c. Everyone cheered

3. What did the turtle teach Freddy?

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The Two Goats and the Narrow Bridge

Two goats met in the middle of a narrow bridge over a stream. Neither would step back. I was here first, said one. No, I was, said the other. They pushed and pushed until, splash! Both tumbled into the water. Wet and shivering, they climbed out. If we had taken turns, said one, we would both be dry.

1. What is the moral of this fable?
 - a. Goats cannot swim.
 - b. Bridges are dangerous.
 - c. Taking turns is better than fighting.
2. Why did the goats fall in the water?
 - a. They pushed each other
 - b. The wind blew
 - c. The bridge broke
3. What did the goats learn?

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The Clever Mouse and the Cheese Trap

Milo the mouse smelled cheese in the kitchen. But he saw a shiny trap beside it. He did not rush in. Instead, he watched and waited. He saw the trap snap shut on a falling spoon. Milo smiled and nibbled crumbs far from the trap. Thinking first kept him safe.

1. What is the moral of this fable?

- a. Traps are fun.
- b. Think before you act.
- c. Cheese is the best food.

2. Why did Milo wait?

- a. He saw the trap
- b. He was sleepy
- c. He was not hungry

3. What snapped the trap shut?

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Pippa the Parrot Who Listened

Pippa the parrot loved to talk, but she never listened. One day, her friend Tiko the toucan said, A storm is coming! Pippa kept chattering and missed the warning. The wind blew her nest apart. After that, Pippa learned to close her beak and open her ears.

1. What is the moral of this fable?
 - a. Parrots talk too much.
 - b. Storms ruin nests.
 - c. Listening is just as important as talking.
2. What warning did Pippa miss?
 - a. A cat was near
 - b. Lunch was ready
 - c. A storm was coming
3. What did Pippa learn?

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The Bear Who Counted Stars

Bruno the bear wanted to catch a falling star. Every night he reached up, but the stars stayed far away. His friend, a small bat, said, You cannot catch stars, but you can enjoy them. Bruno lay back and counted stars instead. He counted one hundred every night.

1. What is the moral of this fable?
 - a. Bats are good at counting.
 - b. Some things are for enjoying, not owning.
 - c. Bears cannot reach high.
2. What did Bruno want to do?
 - a. Fly to the moon
 - b. Catch a falling star
 - c. Climb a tree
3. How many stars did Bruno count each night?

Fables & Morals: Set 2

Grade 3 Reading Worksheet

The Elephant and the Firefly

Ella the elephant felt sad because she was so big and clumsy. A tiny firefly named Flick landed on her trunk. Do not be sad, said Flick. Tonight I will show you something. He led her to the pond, where a thousand fireflies glowed on the water. Ella gasped. It was the most beautiful sight she had ever seen.

1. What is the moral of this fable?

- a. Elephants are clumsy.
- b. Every friend, big or small, has something special to share.
- c. Fireflies live in ponds.

2. Why did Ella feel sad?

- a. She felt big and clumsy
- b. She was lost
- c. She was hungry

3. What did Flick show Ella?

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Grade 3 Reading Worksheet

Momo the Monkey and the Mango Tree

Momo the monkey loved mangoes, but the best ones grew on the tallest branch. He jumped and jumped but could not reach. Instead of giving up, he stacked fallen logs into steps. Up he climbed and picked the sweetest mango. He shared it with his little sister.

1. What is the moral of this fable?
 - a. Smart thinking beats just trying harder.
 - b. Mangoes grow on tall trees.
 - c. Monkeys like to jump.
2. How did Momo reach the mangoes?
 - a. He flew up
 - b. He shook the tree
 - c. He stacked logs into steps
3. Who did Momo share the mango with?

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Grade 3 Reading Worksheet

Lulu the Lamb and the Dark

Lulu the lamb was afraid of the dark. Every night she cried for the moon to stay. Her mother gave her a tiny lantern. It is not the dark you fear, said her mother. It is not knowing what is there. With her lantern, Lulu saw that the dark held only soft hay and kind shadows. She slept soundly after that.

1. What is the moral of this fable?
 - a. The moon stays all night.
 - b. Lambs need lanterns.
 - c. Understanding takes away fear.

2. What was Lulu afraid of?
 - a. The dark
 - b. The wolf
 - c. Thunder

3. What did Lulu see with her lantern?
